



GOING *Green*

Shifting to green manufacturing is not only economically profitable but also ecologically beneficial

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Going green seems to be the trend once again. Consumer electronics biggies such as LG, BenQ, Samsung, Philips, Godrej and many others are all smitten by the green bug. They are realising the importance of becoming more responsible towards the environment and finding that green manufacturing initiatives offer market advantages and an edge over competitors. "Manufacturers can actually save money by manufacturing greener products and adopting greener manufacturing processes," says Amitabh Tiwari, business group marketing head, home entertainment, LG Electronics.

Green manufacturing and management is all about designing products using green technologies, that is eco-friendly technologies, and also making the manufacturing process

environmental friendly. The green manufacturing movement emerged in the 1970s but the craze declined only to surface again in the 1990s and decline again. Industry analysts believe that this time the green manufacturing movement is here to stay. "There is very serious interest within the industry to make manufacturing and gadgets green," says Vivek Tyagi, country manager, Sales, Freescale Semiconductor India. "We are currently witnessing a shift in philosophy, with an acceptance and emphasis towards going green," he adds.

Manufacturers are being motivated to go green by spiralling energy costs, growing concerns about the future of non-renewable resources, surging consumer demand for eco-friendly products and processes and environmental sustainability. As more and more manufacturers incorporate sustainable manufactur-

ing processes and churn out green products, they see measurable energy savings, reduced carbon emissions and the emergence of a wide range of green technologies and products. "Green manufacturing, no doubt, reduces costs, improves process efficiency and encourages development of new eco-friendly products," confirms a BenQ spokesperson.

What it actually means

Many people think that green production simply entails instituting pollution controls, meeting quality standards or recycling products. The reality, however, is that green manufacturing aims to minimise the negative impact of manufacturing on the environment, at every stage. Green production also means that companies transform their input and output processes—from processing raw material to producing the end product. "The main purpose